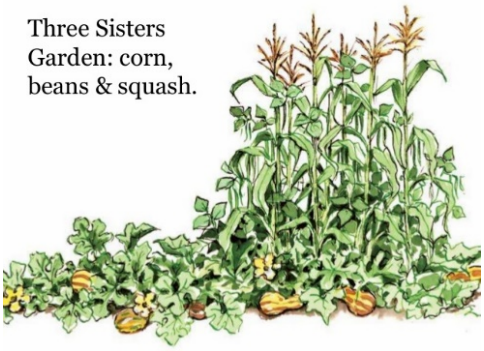

Three Sisters Garden: corn, beans & squash.

Three Sister's Soup

1 recipe/unit; Yield: 4 medium bowls

The bean plants climb up around the corn stalks. The large squash leaves shade the ground and keep it moist and control weeds. They were traditionally planted together, the Elders got it right.

25 ml vegetable oil
1 small onion, diced
2 cloves of garlic, finely chopped
1000 ml vegetable or chicken broth
400 ml diced acorn or butternut squash, peeled & seeds removed, medium dice
250 ml corn kernels (fresh, canned or frozen)
½ apple, peeled and diced
125 ml dried split lentils
2.5 ml basil
2.5 ml thyme
1 bay leaf
1 ml chili flakes
1 ml black pepper
Salt to taste
200 ml kidney beans, drained
200 ml green beans (fresh or frozen)

Directions:

1. Wash, peel and dice all vegetables. Drain beans.
2. Heat oil in a large pot and sauté diced onion and minced garlic.
3. Add squash, corn, apple, and red lentils sauté for 3 to 5 minutes.
4. Add broth, thyme, chili and pepper and simmer for 10 minutes.
5. Add the canned kidney beans and green beans and simmer for the last 10-15 minutes or until vegetables are tender.
6. Serve hot with a hearty slice of whole grain bread or bannock.

- Note: Prepare stock with 30 ml Better than Bouillon and 1000 ml hot water.